

ÆTHERIUM CODEX — ICONIC SPELLS

10 Per College | Alpha Draft | Mechanics Per Book of Shadows v6

Format Key:

- ESL = Effective Spell Level (lesser of Effect Tier and Subtype Tier)
- ÆP Cost = $(ESL \times 2) - 1$
- CP = Construction Points (geometry budget): Pool = $(\frac{1}{2} \text{ Effect Tier}) + (\frac{1}{2} \text{ Subtype Tier}) + \text{Mastery} + \text{Integrity}$
- Additives paid from Complexity Pool | Target/Range/Duration paid from CP
- Base state free: Individual target, Close range, Instantaneous duration
- Architect recipes receive Final Rank reduction: -4 at ESL 1–4, -3 at ESL 5–7, -2 at ESL 8–10
- [A] = Architect (Studied) | [I] = Improviser (Innate)

1. MORTIS AEVUM COLLEGIUM

Discipline: Eschatology | Primary subtypes: Death/Undeath, Life, Mind, Poison

1.1 — The Still Verse [A]

Eschatology's signature combat form. A single anatomically precise strike delivered through magical focus, targeting the gap between armor and life.

- **Effect:** Damage | **Subtype:** Death/Undeath
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Insidious +2 (the damage manifests as internal failure, no visible wound)
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2 (touch-range only, cannot be increased)
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Additives 2 – Subtractives 2 = Rank 6; Architect -3 = **ESL 3**
- **ÆP Cost:** 5
- **Use Case:** The surgeon's signature touch attack. Delivers necrotic damage that reads as natural organ failure to non-magical examination. Primary weapon of the Still Verse style.

1.2 — Surgeon's Assessment [A]

A rapid diagnostic scan that reads the subject's current condition tracks, active poisons, diseases, and structural damage.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Life
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 – 2 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)

- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Touch a creature and read all four condition tracks, active status conditions, ongoing poisons/diseases, and remaining HP pools. Standard pre-treatment assessment.

1.3 — Knit [A]

Rapid targeted healing of physical damage. The surgeon's workhorse restoration effect.

- **Effect:** Healing | **Subtype:** Life
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 2 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Closes wounds, restores Physical HP. The most-cast spell in the setting. Every surgeon knows it.

1.4 — Purgation [A]

Forcibly expels poison or disease from a subject's system via metabolic acceleration.

- **Effect:** Panacea | **Subtype:** Life
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2, Ritual Components (verbal) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 3 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Removes all active Poison and Disease conditions simultaneously. Requires touch and spoken diagnostic formula. Standard field surgeon tool.

1.5 — Wasting Touch [A]

Drains the target's physical vitality, reducing their Might and Vigor temporarily.

- **Effect:** Weaken | **Subtype:** Death/Undeath
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 - 2 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Temporarily reduces the target's Physical attributes. Used in subdual operations and surgical pre-treatment to prevent a patient from thrashing.

****1.6 — Soul Anchor** [A]**

Stabilizes a dying creature's soul within its body, preventing departure for a short time.

- ****Effect:**** Immortality | ****Subtype:**** Life
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Close Range Only -2, Limited (only on creatures at 0 HP or dying) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 5 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 - 4 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** Buys time. A creature stabilized with Soul Anchor will not die or have their soul depart for the duration. Does not restore HP. Gives the surgeon time to work.

****1.7 — Carrion Resilience** [I]**

The Carrion Heart's signature self-enhancement. The caster temporarily suppresses pain receptors and biological limiters, fighting past injury thresholds.

- ****Effect:**** Enhanced Trait | ****Subtype:**** Death/Undeath
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Toggleable +1
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (self only) -1
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 - 1 = Rank 6; ****ESL 6**** (Improviser — no reduction)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 11
- ****Use Case:**** Enhances Vigor and provides resistance to the Wounded and Crippled condition steps. The signature buff of the Carrion Heart practitioner. The caster feels no pain penalty but accumulates damage normally — they simply ignore the mechanical consequences until the spell ends.

****1.8 — Recall the Departed** [A]**

Calls the recently deceased soul back into its body for brief communication. The soul can answer questions; it cannot lie.

- ****Effect:**** Communication | ****Subtype:**** Death/Undeath
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Concentration (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (target must have died within 24 hours) -3, Ritual Components (verbal + somatic) -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 7 = Rank -2; minimum ****ESL 1****; Architect -4 (floored)

= **ESL 1**

- **ÆP Cost:** 1

- **Use Case:** The forensic surgeon's most valuable tool. The soul cannot lie and answers questions about the circumstances of death, last observations, and any information it holds. Highly restricted in legal use — Deepguard holds the contract authority for sanctioned interrogations.

1.9 — Necrotic Field [A]

Projects a zone of death-energy that suppresses healing and accelerates condition track degradation.

- **Effect:** Environment | **Subtype:** Death/Undeath

- **Target:** Emanation (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)

- **Additives:** none

- **Subtractives:** Uncentered Area -1 (caster is within the field), Concentration -2

- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 3 = Rank 2; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)

- **ÆP Cost:** 1

- **Use Case:** Creates an aura around the caster. All healing effects within the field are halved. Creatures in the field move one step down their Physical condition track each round they remain. Used in the Carrion Heart tradition to sustain extended fights.

1.10 — Animate Sanctioned [A]

Animates a prepared corpse as a Sanctioned Undead assistant under the caster's direction. Requires a soul stone and Mortis Aevum authorization.

- **Effect:** Summon | **Subtype:** Death/Undeath

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)

- **Additives:** none

- **Subtractives:** Requires Vessel -1 (requires prepared corpse), Limited (requires soul stone and valid authorization) -2, Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3

- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 - 8 = Rank 0; minimum **ESL 1**; Architect -4 (floored) = **ESL 1**

- **ÆP Cost:** 1

- **Use Case:** The official, legal version of undead animation. Produces a functional undead worker that follows instructions and is automatically logged in the Mortis Aevum census. Without the authorization subtractive removed (and proper licensing), this spell produces Unsanctioned Undead and is a crime.

2. STORMPEAK COMMAND ACADEMY

Discipline: Fulmination | Primary subtypes: Electricity, Fire, Æther, Cold, Force

****2.1 — Tactical Burst** [A]**

The Phalanx's standard area suppression. A precise burst of force energy delivered to a defined radius.

- ****Effect:**** Damage | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Burst/Small (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Selective +1 (exclude allies in burst)
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 6; Architect -3 = ****ESL 3****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 5
- ****Use Case:**** Standard area denial. The Selective additive means trained Phalanx formations can fire this into a melee without hitting their own. The workhorse of Stormpeak's offensive line.

****2.2 — Positive Energy Strike** [A]**

Battlefield healing — a burst of evoked positive energy that closes wounds in nearby allies.

- ****Effect:**** Healing | ****Subtype:**** Life
- ****Target:**** Burst/Small (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Close (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Selective +1 (allies only)
- ****Subtractives:**** Uncentered Area -1 (caster is within burst)
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Additives 1 - 1 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** The battlefield medic's standard. Heals all allies in close range simultaneously. Low ESL because Stormpeak healers are trained for speed, not depth — this is the "keep everyone fighting" spell, not the "save someone from death's door" spell.

****2.3 — Force Wall** [A]**

A standard Wall of Force — instantaneous barrier deployed to control battlefield geometry.

- ****Effect:**** Create | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Wall/Standard (3 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Concentration -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Target 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 - 2 = Rank 8; Architect -3 = ****ESL 5****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9

- **Use Case:** Deploys a solid force barrier to split a battlefield, block a corridor, or protect a flank. Requires concentration. The Army Corps of Engineers role Stormpeak graduates fulfill in civilian life often uses this spell for construction and emergency infrastructure.

2.4 — Lightning Arc [A]

A standard single-target electrical strike with chain capability.

- **Effect:** Damage | **Subtype:** Electricity
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Chain +3 (arcs to one secondary target)
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 1 + Subtype 4 + Range 1 + Additives 3 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** Primary single-target damage. The chain makes it efficient against grouped enemies. Standard issue for graduating officers.

2.5 — Contingency Ward [A]

Stormpeak's signature passive defense. A pre-set spell that triggers automatically when a specific condition is met.

- **Effect:** Protection | **Subtype:** Æther
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Day (3 CP)
- **Additives:** Triggered +2 (activates on specified condition), Suspended +3 (held until trigger)
- **Subtractives:** Limited (trigger condition must be specified at casting) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 5 - 1 = Rank 12; Architect -2 = **ESL 10**
- **ÆP Cost:** 19
- **Use Case:** Stormpeak's defining spell. Cast in the morning; triggers automatically when the specified condition occurs (e.g., "when I am struck while below half HP"). The entire curriculum on Contingency exists to produce graduates who can build these reliably.

2.6 — Suppression Bolt [A]

A cold-infused projectile that slows target movement and imposes a Reeling condition.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Cold
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = **ESL**

4**

- **ÆP Cost:** 7

- **Use Case:** Imposes the Reeling condition (Physical Track Step 2) and halves movement speed. Used to control enemy positioning in the Phalanx doctrine — slow their advance, hold your line.

2.7 — Burn Through [A]

Concentrated fire delivery optimized to overcome protection and armor.

- **Effect:** Damage | **Subtype:** Fire

- **Target:** Ray (0 CP) | **Range:** Long (2 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)

- **Additives:** Penetrating (Tier 1) +2

- **Subtractives:** none

- **Final Rank:** Effect 1 + Subtype 4 + Range 2 + Additives 2 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**

- **ÆP Cost:** 11

- **Use Case:** Penetrates Impervious defenses. Standard siege application — the Vanguard doctrine's answer to heavily armored targets.

2.8 — Positive Energy Surge [A]

Mass emergency healing at range. The advanced version of Positive Energy Strike for larger unit engagements.

- **Effect:** Healing | **Subtype:** Life

- **Target:** Burst/Small (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)

- **Additives:** Selective +1, Empower (via Metamagic Talent) — noted but not baked in

- **Subtractives:** none

- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = **ESL 4**

- **ÆP Cost:** 7

- **Use Case:** Heals all selected targets in a medium-range burst. Used at the command level to stabilize a unit after taking fire. Higher ESL than the standard version — more power per casting.

2.9 — Force Cage [A]

Imprisons a single target in a small cage of solid force, immobilizing them without harm.

- **Effect:** Create | **Subtype:** Æther

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)

- **Additives:** Reversible +1

- **Subtractives:** Limited (target must be size Medium or smaller) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 - 1 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = **ESL 4**
- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** Creates a solid force enclosure around the target. They are Restrained and cannot escape without breaking the effect. The Reversible additive lets the caster release them as a free action. Used in capture operations and prisoner control.

2.10 — Tactical Assessment Burst [A]

A brief flash of force energy that reveals position, trajectory, and armor value of all targets in an area — a divination-adjacent use of Evocation energy.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Æther
- **Target:** Burst/Small (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Reveals the Soak, Threshold, and current condition track status of all creatures in the burst radius. Used by Stormpeak officers to assess a battlefield instantly. The Praxeology / Fulmination border — tactical analysis through direct energy pulse.

3. DEEPGUARD ACADEMY

Discipline: Sigilry | Primary subtypes: Order/Law, Æther, Earth, Artifice, Metal | Secondary: Runic

3.1 — Binding Sigil [A]

The foundational Deepguard ward. Inscribes a rune that triggers an Affliction on any creature that crosses it without authorization.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Order/Law
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Day (3 CP)
- **Additives:** Triggered +2 (activates on unauthorized crossing), Suspended +3
- **Subtractives:** Increased Action (10 minutes) -3, Ritual Components -2, Requires Vessel -1 (must be inscribed on a surface)
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 5 - 6 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = **ESL 4**
- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** The core security tool. Any creature touching the inscribed surface without the

correct authorization triggers the Affliction (GM determines degree based on ESL). Deepguard sells these as commercial products.

****3.2 — Iron Contract** [A]**

Magically binds a spoken or written agreement between two parties. Violation causes immediate metaphysical backlash.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Order/Law
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Weeks (5 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Triggered +2 (triggers on violation of stated terms), Suspended +3, Affects Others +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2, Limited (only affects parties who consent to the terms) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 5 + Additives 7 - 6 = Rank 11; Architect -2 = ****ESL 9****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 17
- ****Use Case:**** The Deepguard contract. Both parties must consent and be present. Violation triggers a significant Affliction against the violating party. High ESL reflects how hard these are to cast — only senior Deepguard contractors can produce them reliably.

****3.3 — Layered Ward** [A]**

Protective aura inscribed on a surface or object. Adds Soak to everything within the warded area.

- ****Effect:**** Protection | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Emanation (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Day (3 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Affects Objects +2, Tenacious +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Requires Vessel -1
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 4 - 3 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = ****ESL 6****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 11
- ****Use Case:**** Inscribed on walls, doors, or vault interiors. Everything within the emanation gains enhanced Soak. Tenacious makes it harder to dispel. Standard vault lining in all Deepguard-secured facilities.

****3.4 — Runic Lock** [A]**

Seals a door, container, or passage with a magical lock that cannot be opened without the specific runic key.

- ****Effect:**** Nullify | ****Subtype:**** Order/Law

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Week (4 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Objects +2, Innate +2 (cannot be nullified by standard magic)
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Requires Vessel -1, Limited (only affects the specific object touched) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 4 + Additives 4 - 4 = Rank 10; Architect -2 = **ESL 8**
- **ÆP Cost:** 15
- **Use Case:** Nullifies all attempts to open, phase through, or teleport through the sealed object. The Innate additive means standard counter-magic cannot remove it — only the correct key or a Warden Breaker talent can overcome it.

3.5 — Kobold's Snare [A]

A runic trap that Restrains the first creature to trigger it.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Artifice
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** Triggered +2, Suspended +3, Delayed Activation (must be pre-cast) -1 (used as Subtractive)
- **Subtractives:** Delayed Activation -1, Requires Vessel -1, Limited (triggers on physical contact with inscribed surface) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 5 - 4 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = **ESL 4**
- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** Pre-cast as a trap. When a creature steps on the inscribed surface, they are immediately Restrained. Used by Patient Snare practitioners and in commercial security installations.

3.6 — Construct Guardian [A]

Animates a prepared construct or golem body as a security guardian under the caster's direction.

- **Effect:** Summon | **Subtype:** Artifice
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** Tethered +2 (uses Mastery Capacity Pool while active)
- **Subtractives:** Requires Vessel -1, Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 - 6 = Rank 4; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Activates a pre-built construct to serve as guardian. The Tethered additive means it requires ongoing Mastery Capacity Pool reservation — the caster is aware of it and

can issue commands. The construct follows standing orders if the caster is incapacitated.

****3.7 — Abjuration Shell** [A]**

Creates a personal force barrier that provides significant protection from physical and magical damage.

- ****Effect:**** Protection | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Toggleable +1
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = ****ESL 4****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 7
- ****Use Case:**** Standard personal protection for field agents. Provides a Soak bonus for the duration. Toggleable — can be dismissed and reactivated freely without recasting, important for close-quarters work where the shell might interfere with the caster's own traps.

****3.8 — Dispel Ward** [A]**

Counter-magic focused on unraveling established magical effects in an area.

- ****Effect:**** Nullify | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Burst/Small (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = ****ESL 4****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 7
- ****Use Case:**** Removes active magical effects in the burst area. Against hostile spells this is reactive counter-magic. Deepguard agents use it to sweep a location before securing it — remove any lingering effects left by the previous occupants.

****3.9 — Stone Entomb** [A]**

The Inevitable Key's signature offensive technique. Causes stone or earth near the target to surge up and encase them.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Earth
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Close (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Transforming +3 (third-degree result is fully encased in stone, effectively Petrified)
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (requires stone or earth within Close range) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 3 - 2 = Rank 7; Architect -3 =

****ESL 4****

- ****ÆP Cost:** 7**

- ****Use Case:**** Afflicts target through three degrees: Restrained → Buried (Incapacitated) → Entombed (Transformed/Petrified). Requires proximity to earth or stone. Deepguard's field retrieval teams use this when they need to bring someone in alive but immobile.

****3.10 — Soul-Drive Interface** [A]**

Connects a preserved soul stone to a Deepguard construct housing, allowing the soul to function as a processing unit — the Soul-Drive battery. Highly classified.

- ****Effect:**** Communication | ****Subtype:**** Artifice

- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Permanent (10 CP)

- ****Additives:**** Released +4 (self-sustaining)

- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 hour) -4, Requires Vessel -1, Limited (requires a valid soul stone and a prepared construct housing) -2

- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 10 + Additives 4 - 9 = Rank 10; Architect -2 =

****ESL 8****

- ****ÆP Cost:** 15**

- ****Use Case:**** Deepguard's covert function. The soul in the stone interfaces with the construct's systems, acting as the "intelligence" that manages complex security responses. The soul is aware but cannot refuse — a property of the soul reading process. Only Deepguard's inner cadre can cast this.

4. THE CHIAROSCURO INSTITUTE

***Discipline:** Aetheric Metacreativity | **Primary subtypes:** Imagination, Mind, Shadow/Darkness, Light, Emotion*

****4.1 — Mirror Image** [I]**

Projects multiple illusory duplicates of the caster, making them difficult to target.

- ****Effect:**** Illusion | ****Subtype:**** Imagination

- ****Target:**** Emanation (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)

- ****Additives:**** none

- ****Subtractives:**** none

- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 = Rank 6; ****ESL 6**** (Improviser — no reduction)

- ****ÆP Cost:** 11**

- ****Use Case:**** The caster is surrounded by 1d4+1 illusory duplicates. Each successful attack against the caster has a chance to hit a duplicate instead. Standard defensive setup for the

Inconstant Moon style.

****4.2 — Phantom Pain** [I]**

Delivers illusory sensory input directly to the target's mind, causing them to experience injury they haven't received.

- ****Effect:**** Damage | ****Subtype:**** Mind
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Insidious +2 (target believes injury is real)
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Additives 2 = Rank 7; ****ESL 7**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 13
- ****Use Case:**** Deals Mental HP damage rather than Physical. The Insidious additive means the target believes they are physically injured. Useful for creating false medical records — a target treated by a non-Chiaroscuro surgeon will show no physical injury despite their mental distress.

****4.3 — The Veiled Step** [I]**

Renders the caster invisible to mundane sight.

- ****Effect:**** Concealment | ****Subtype:**** Shadow/Darkness
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (ends immediately if caster attacks or casts offensively) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 - 2 = Rank 5; ****ESL 5**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9
- ****Use Case:**** Standard invisibility. The Limited subtractive drops it when the caster acts offensively — appropriate for the Silent Step style, which is designed to end the fight in one move before invisibility becomes irrelevant.

****4.4 — Aetheric Weaving** [A]**

The discipline's namesake. Constructs a multi-sensory illusion in a defined area — sight, sound, smell, and temperature.

- ****Effect:**** Illusion | ****Subtype:**** Imagination
- ****Target:**** Spread (2 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Concentration (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Concentration -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Target 2 + Range 1 - 2 = Rank 7; Architect -3 = ****ESL 4**** (available as Architect when pre-designed)

- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** The Institute's flagship product. Creates a fully interactive illusory environment affecting all senses. Used for entertainment, intelligence operations, and the Mirage Resort's signature experiences. Requires concentration — the caster must maintain it actively.

4.5 — Doubt [I]

Projects targeted emotional uncertainty into the subject, reducing their confidence and imposing penalties on Social checks.

- **Effect:** Weaken | **Subtype:** Emotion
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** Insidious +2, Subtle +1
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 + Additives 3 = Rank 11; **ESL 11** (Improviser — Epic tier)
- **ÆP Cost:** 21
- **Use Case:** Reduces target's Presence and Composure temporarily. The Insidious additive means the target has no idea they're being magically affected — they simply feel uncertain. Used by the Adamant Heart style and Chiaroscuro intelligence operatives.

4.6 — Glamour [I]

Alters the caster's apparent appearance, voice, and physical features to convincingly imitate another person.

- **Effect:** Morph | **Subtype:** Imagination
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** Subtle +2 (imperceptible to non-magical senses)
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 = Rank 9; **ESL 9** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 17
- **Use Case:** Full visual and auditory disguise lasting hours. Does not change scent, magical aura, or soul stone signature. Used by Silent Step operatives for identity work. The Institute teaches this as part of their standard curriculum.

4.7 — Sim-Stim Imprint [A]

Records a sensory and emotional experience from a willing (or magically compliant) subject for later playback.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Imagination

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Objects +2 (records into a gem circlet), Insidious +2 (subject may not perceive the emotional extraction)
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Additives 4 - 4 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** The Aetheric Echo product line. Records the subject's sensory state into a prepared gem circlet. The commercial version requires full consent. The asylum version uses the Insidious additive. The recording can be played back by anyone holding the circlet.

4.8 — Light Sculpture [A]

Creates a persistent, complex visual illusion not requiring concentration — a "recorded" image that loops.

- **Effect:** Illusion | **Subtype:** Light
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Day (3 CP)
- **Additives:** Tethered +2
- **Subtractives:** Limited (visual only, no sound or tactile component) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 2 - 1 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** Creates a looping visual illusion that persists without concentration (Tethered to Mastery Capacity Pool). Used for advertising, entertainment, and security — a convincing image of a guarded door that loops indefinitely.

4.9 — Collective Perception [I]

Links the sensory experience of the caster to a willing target, allowing both to share perception simultaneously.

- **Effect:** Remote Sensing | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Others +2
- **Subtractives:** Limited (willing target only) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Additives 2 - 1 = Rank 7; **ESL 7** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 13
- **Use Case:** The caster sees through the target's eyes and the target sees through the caster's simultaneously. Used in coordinated operations — the Institute's field operatives use this to allow a remote coordinator to see what the agent sees in real time.

****4.10 — Gilded Shackle** [A]**

The Institute's covert control infrastructure. Imposes a persistent, invisible perceptual overlay on a target that filters their experience of their environment.

- ****Effect:**** Illusion | ****Subtype:**** Imagination
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Weeks (5 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Insidious +2, Subtle +2, Innate +2, Tenacious +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 hour) -4
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 5 + Additives 8 - 6 = Rank 13; Architect -2 = ****ESL 11**** (Epic tier)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 21
- ****Use Case:**** The Chiaroscuro Institute's covert function. The subject perceives their environment as comfortable, rewarding, and appropriate — poverty reads as modest contentment; danger reads as routine. Persists for weeks, is imperceptible to non-magical senses, and resists standard counter-magic. Only available to Institute inner cadre. *This spell is a crime if cast without consent.*

5. THE SOVEREIGN EXCHANGE

Discipline: Limenology | Primary subtypes: Space, Order/Law, Fate, Æther | Secondary: Planar

****5.1 — Threshold Step** [A]**

Instantaneous teleportation to a prepared location within range.

- ****Effect:**** Teleport | ****Subtype:**** Space
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (destination must be a prepared circle or known location) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 - 2 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** The Exchange's standard personal teleport. The Limited subtractive means only prepared circles — the Exchange's proprietary network — are valid destinations, which is also what gives the Exchange its logistical monopoly. Commercially licensed graduates cannot teleport outside the network.

****5.2 — Binding Oath** [A]**

Establishes a lesser magical contract. Both parties suffer the Weakened condition if they violate

its terms.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Order/Law
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Week (4 CP)
- **Additives:** Triggered +2, Suspended +3, Affects Others +2
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Limited (willing parties only, terms must be spoken aloud) -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 4 + Additives 7 - 6 = Rank 10; Architect -2 = **ESL 8**
- **ÆP Cost:** 15
- **Use Case:** The standard commercial contract. Both parties are present, consent, and state terms aloud. Violation weakens the violating party. A simplified version of the Iron Contract — used in everyday Exchange business.

5.3 — Planar Courier [A]

Sends a small physical object (up to 5 lbs) through the teleportation network to a prepared destination.

- **Effect:** Teleport | **Subtype:** Space
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Unlimited (7 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Objects +2
- **Subtractives:** Limited (destination must be a prepared Exchange circle) -2, Limited (5 lb weight limit) -1, Ritual Components -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Range 7 + Additives 2 - 4 = Rank 11; Architect -2 = **ESL 9**
- **ÆP Cost:** 17
- **Use Case:** Package delivery across the continent. The commercial product that funds the Exchange's circle network. Requires high-tier casting — only licensed Exchange graduates can use the Unlimited range without network restriction.

5.4 — Summon Lesser Entity [A]

Calls a bound contractual entity to perform a specific task. The entity is contractually obligated — it cannot refuse the stated terms.

- **Effect:** Summon | **Subtype:** Order/Law
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** Tethered +2
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3, Limited (entity must have an existing contract with the caster or the Exchange) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 - 7 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1

- **Use Case:** Not a standard Summon — the entity is a pre-contracted being held in the Exchange's registry. The Limited subtractive means you're calling something you already have a deal with, not pulling something from the void. The contract is Limenology's signature distinction from raw Conjunction.

5.5 — Probability Read [A]

A brief divination that reveals the most likely outcome of a proposed action before it is taken.

- **Effect:** Remote Sensing | **Subtype:** Fate
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Limited (one specific proposed action per casting) -2, Ritual Components -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 3 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** The caster proposes an action and receives a brief probability assessment — likely success, likely failure, likely complication. Used in the Exchange's risk management operations. Not a guarantee — a probability read can be wrong if the situation changes between casting and action.

5.6 — Force of Contract [A]

Projects the weight of a violated contract into a physical strike, dealing damage proportional to the severity of the breach.

- **Effect:** Damage | **Subtype:** Order/Law
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Limited (only against creatures in active violation of a Deepguard or Exchange contract) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 - 2 = Rank 3; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Enforcement magic. Against a creature in active contract violation, this deals significant damage. Against someone not in violation, it is a weak force bolt. The Binding Contract covert style's primary offensive spell — the enforcer doesn't need general damage capacity, just the ability to hurt people who owe.

5.7 — Dimensional Pocket [A]

Creates a stable extradimensional storage space accessible to the caster only.

- **Effect:** Create | **Subtype:** Space

- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Day (3 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Objects +2
- **Subtractives:** Limited (caster access only) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 2 - 1 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** Creates a small extradimensional space. The caster can store and retrieve objects from it as a standard action. Volume roughly equivalent to a large chest. Standard courier equipment for Exchange agents.

5.8 — Intercept Threshold [A]

Blocks all teleportation effects attempting to cross a defined boundary.

- **Effect:** Nullify | **Subtype:** Space
- **Target:** Wall/Standard (3 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** Tenacious +2
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Target 3 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 - 5 = Rank 8; Architect -3 = **ESL 5**
- **ÆP Cost:** 9
- **Use Case:** Creates an invisible planar barrier. Nothing can teleport through it. Used to secure high-value locations — if an area has an Intercept Threshold active, the Exchange's teleportation network cannot access it. Also used by Deepguard when they need to prevent emergency extraction from a secured facility.

5.9 — Planar Analysis [A]

Reads the planar signature of an area, identifying nearby bleeds, active teleportation circles, and extradimensional spaces.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Space
- **Target:** Emanation (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Standard survey tool for Exchange agents entering new territory. Reveals all active planar effects in the area — teleportation circles (and who registered them), extradimensional storage spaces, planar bleed zones, and active Dimensional or Planar Additive effects.

****5.10 — Mass Threshold** [A]**

Teleports an entire group through the Exchange network simultaneously.

- ****Effect:**** Teleport | ****Subtype:**** Space
- ****Target:**** Burst/Small (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Affects Others +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2, Limited (destination must be prepared Exchange circle) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Additives 2 - 6 = Rank 2; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** Moves an entire party through a prepared circle simultaneously. The cornerstone of the Exchange's mass logistics operation — armies can be moved, not just individuals. The strict network limitation (Limited subtractive) means this cannot be used for unauthorized teleportation. Very low ESL because the actual complexity is in the circle preparation, not the casting.

6. THE UNITY ACADEMY

Discipline: Noetics | Primary subtypes: Mind, Emotion, Psionic | Secondary: Psionic

****6.1 — Adamant Presence** [I]**

Projects an aura of unshakeable calm that imposes a penalty on enemy Social attacks and resistance to fear effects.

- ****Effect:**** Protection | ****Subtype:**** Mind
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Toggleable +1
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 7; ****ESL 7**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 13
- ****Use Case:**** The Adamant Heart's defensive foundation. While active, the caster is immune to Fear effects and all attempts to damage their Reputation Pool are at -2. The Toggleable additive allows them to switch it off when they want to appear emotionally readable.

****6.2 — Psychic Lance** [I]**

A focused beam of mental force that deals Mental HP damage directly.

- ****Effect:**** Damage | ****Subtype:**** Mind

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 = Rank 5; **ESL 5** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 9
- **Use Case:** Deals damage to the Mental HP pool rather than Physical. Against creatures that are mentally fragile or have already been moved down their Mental condition track, this is more efficient than conventional attack. Unity field agents use this as their primary offensive tool.

6.3 — Compulsion [I]

Forces a target to follow a single stated instruction on their next action.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Limited (one simple instruction; cannot compel self-harm) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 2 = Rank 3; **ESL 3** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 5
- **Use Case:** The target performs one simple instructed action on their next turn. They are aware they were compelled afterward. Used by Unity agents for quick tactical redirects — "drop the weapon," "open the door," "step back."

6.4 — Emotional Anchor [A]

Stabilizes the emotional state of a distressed or mentally deteriorating target.

- **Effect:** Healing | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 - 2 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Restores Mental HP and pauses further deterioration of the Mental condition track. The legitimate therapeutic product. The asylum's most-used restoration spell — Unity surgeons of the mind use this constantly.

6.5 — Psychic Read [I]

Scans the surface thoughts of a target. They are aware of the attempt unless the Insidious

additive is applied.

- **Effect:** Mind Reading | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 = Rank 6; **ESL 6** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** The standard diagnostic tool for therapeutic work. Reads surface thoughts — what the target is consciously thinking right now. Not deep memory access. The therapist's version requires consent; the intelligence version uses Insidious, making it a surveillance tool.

6.6 — Deep Archive [A]

Accesses and reads a target's specific memories. Requires significant effort — this is not a quick scan.

- **Effect:** Mind Reading | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2, Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3, Limited (target must be willing or incapacitated) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 9 = Rank -3; minimum **ESL 1**; Architect -4 (floored) = **ESL 1**
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Deep memory access. Reads specific memories rather than surface thoughts. The therapeutic version is slow, consent-based, and used to help process trauma. The intelligence version is performed on incapacitated subjects. The soul stone reading at Mortis Aevum is a related but separate process — this reads the living mind, not the recorded soul.

6.7 — Shepherd's Command [I]

Projects an aura of directional authority over a group, allowing the caster to issue non-verbal tactical instructions that all nearby allies receive simultaneously.

- **Effect:** Communication | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Emanation (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Selective +1 (allies only)
- **Subtractives:** Concentration -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Additives 1 - 2 = Rank 4; **ESL 4** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** All selected allies within Close range receive the caster's tactical intentions instantly — where to move, who to target, when to hold. No verbal component. Used by the Shepherd and Flock practitioners to coordinate large-scale pacification operations silently.

****6.8 — Thrallherd Touch** [A]**

Establishes a subtle persistent psionic influence over a single target, nudging their motivations in a desired direction.

- ****Effect:**** Weaken | ****Subtype:**** Mind
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Week (4 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Insidious +2, Subtle +2, Tenacious +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Close Range Only -2, Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 4 + Additives 6 - 7 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = ****ESL 6****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 11
- ****Use Case:**** Reduces the target's Willpower (Composure and Integrity attributes) and installs a persistent nudge toward desired behaviors. The target has no idea. This is the mechanism by which the Unity Thrallherd network operates at scale. *Casting this without consent is a crime in most jurisdictions, tolerated only within Unity's therapeutic cover.*

****6.9 — Emotional Broadcast** [I]**

Projects a single strong emotion into all creatures in a burst radius.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Emotion
- ****Target:**** Burst/Small (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Selective +1 (exclude allies)
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 8; ****ESL 8**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 15
- ****Use Case:**** Imposes a chosen emotion (fear, despair, calm, euphoria) on all selected targets in the area. Emotion-based Affliction — moves targets down their Social condition track. Used by crowd control specialists to pacify groups without physical force.

****6.10 — Memory Edit** [A]**

Alters or removes a specific memory from a target's mind. The Aetheric Echo product line's most restricted application.

- ****Effect:**** Weaken | ****Subtype:**** Mind
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Permanent (10 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Insidious +2, Innate +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 hour) -4, Close Range Only -2,

Limited (one specific memory per casting) -2

- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 10 + Additives 4 - 10 = Rank 10; Architect -2 = **ESL 8**

- **ÆP Cost:** 15

- **Use Case:** Removes or alters one specific memory permanently. The Innate additive means standard counter-magic cannot restore the memory. Used to protect operational security — Unity's covert function includes memory management for Generalist College intelligence operations. *Classified at the highest level.*

7. WILDPATH WARDENS ACADEMY

Discipline: Ontology | Primary subtypes: Animal, Plant, Life, Poison, Disease | Secondary: Sōmaturgic, Planar (Verdant Font)

7.1 — Primal Shift []

The Primal Form style's foundational technique. Partially transforms the caster's body to emulate a specific creature's physical traits.

- **Effect:** Morph | **Subtype:** Animal

- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)

- **Additives:** Toggleable +1

- **Subtractives:** none

- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 1 = Rank 7; **ESL 7**

(Improviser)

- **ÆP Cost:** 13

- **Use Case:** Grants one specific animal trait — retractile claws, low-light vision, enhanced scent, water breathing. Not full transformation. The Wardens use this for targeted physical adaptation. Toggleable — a scout shifts to scent-tracking and back to normal without recasting.

7.2 — Verdant Font Pulse []

Channels a burst of raw life energy from the caster's implant, healing an adjacent creature.

- **Effect:** Healing | **Subtype:** Life

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)

- **Additives:** none

- **Subtractives:** Sacrifice (Minor) -2 (caster takes 1 Physical damage per casting — the life comes from them)

- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 2 = Rank 3; **ESL 3** (Improviser)

- **ÆP Cost:** 5

- **Use Case:** Emergency healing that costs the caster. For Wildpath graduates with the

Hydra-Strain implant, the personal cost regenerates quickly. For others, use sparingly. The fact that healing here is explicitly paid for in the caster's vitality is Daedalon's theology in spell form.

****7.3 — Neurotoxin** [I]**

Delivers a fast-acting contact poison that imposes the Slowed condition and deals ongoing Physical damage.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Poison
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Secondary Effect +3 (continues to damage the following round)
- ****Subtractives:**** Close Range Only -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 3 - 2 = Rank 7; ****ESL 7**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 13
- ****Use Case:**** Primary Silent Hunt weapon. Contact delivery, works through touch (via a blade coating, bare hands, or thrown splash). Moves the target through their Physical condition track and deals Secondary damage the following round. The Wardens formulate their own variants — GM may allow Improved versions using Warden-specific alchemical sourcing.

****7.4 — Root Trap** [A]**

Causes plant matter in the area to surge upward and Restrain a target.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Plant
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Limited (requires plant matter within Close of target) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Duration 1 - 2 = Rank 5; ****ESL 5**** (Improviser — Wardens primarily Improvise)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9
- ****Use Case:**** Restrains the target with surrounding plant growth. In forests, this is trivially available. In urban environments, the Limited subtractive may make this unavailable entirely. The prep work Wardens do in their operating environments — leaving planted matter nearby — is this spell's force multiplier.

****7.5 — Apex Form** [I]**

Full partial transformation into a large magical beast, granting its physical attributes for the duration.

- ****Effect:**** Growth | ****Subtype:**** Animal
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)

- **Additives:** Enhanced Trait +2 (physical attributes increase with size)
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 2 = Rank 8; **ESL 8** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 15
- **Use Case:** The high-intensity version of Primal Shift. The caster grows in size and their Might and Vigor increase significantly. The Primal Form style's signature combat state. Not full animal transformation — the caster retains human intelligence and can speak.

7.6 — Spore Cloud [I]

Releases a cloud of Verdant Font-infused spores that cause disorientation and impede movement through the area.

- **Effect:** Environment | **Subtype:** Plant
- **Target:** Spread (2 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Uncentered Area -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Target 2 + Duration 1 - 1 = Rank 7; **ESL 7** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 13
- **Use Case:** Creates a region of thick spore-laden air. All creatures in the spread area are at disadvantage on ranged attacks and move at half speed. The caster is within the spread (Uncentered Area). Wildpath agents use this to create kill zones in their prepared territory.

7.7 — Regenerative State [I]

Activates the body's most aggressive repair processes. The caster (or subject) regenerates HP each round automatically.

- **Effect:** Regeneration | **Subtype:** Life
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 = Rank 7; **ESL 7** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 13
- **Use Case:** The biological aspect of Wildpath immortality expressed as a spell. Automatically restores Physical HP each round while active. For graduates with the Hydra-Strain implant, this represents the biological truth of their condition. For others, it is a high-ESL investment in sustained combat.

****7.8 — Predator's Sense** [I]**

Enhances all sensory input to predatory sharpness — scent, peripheral vision, vibration sensitivity.

- ****Effect:**** Senses | ****Subtype:**** Animal
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Hours (2 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 = Rank 7; ****ESL 7**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 13
- ****Use Case:**** Grants enhanced perception — effectively Blindsense at short range, doubles perception range via scent, and grants Danger Sense (cannot be surprised). Standard pre-patrol preparation for Wildpath scouts.

****7.9 — Viral Bloom** [I]**

Introduces an engineered disease into the target that rapidly deteriorates their Physical condition track.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Disease
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Close (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Day (3 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Incurable +2 (cannot be removed by standard Panacea — requires specific Warden antidote)
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components (somatic — must physically contaminate the target) -1
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 3 + Additives 2 - 1 = Rank 9; ****ESL 9**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 17
- ****Use Case:**** Wildpath's most feared weapon. The target deteriorates down their Physical condition track over 24 hours unless treated with a specific Warden-formulated antidote. The Warden holds the cure. Used in capture operations — far more effective leverage than a weapon when you need someone to cooperate.

****7.10 — Soul Retrieve** [I]**

The compact's expression in spell form. Locates a displaced soul in the Palimpsest and anchors it for return to a physical vessel or soul stone.

- ****Effect:**** Dimensional Travel | ****Subtype:**** Life
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Extraplanar (9 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Affects Objects +2 (the soul, treated as an object for transit purposes)
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3, Limited (target soul must be willing or unbound) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 4 + Subtype 3 + Range 9 + Additives 2 - 7 = Rank 11; ****ESL 11****

(Improviser — Epic tier)

- **ÆP Cost:** 21

- **Use Case:** The Dog Tag Directive's mechanical expression. Reaches into the Palimpsest and retrieves a specific displaced soul, returning it to either its body (if present) or a prepared soul stone. Only Wildpath graduates with sufficient Mastery can cast this — the ESL requirement reflects why the compact's immortality was necessary. You need to still be alive long enough to finish the job.

8. THE CHRONOSYNCLASTIC INSTITUTE

Discipline: Praxeology | Primary subtypes: Fate, Time, Mind, Space | Secondary: Planar

8.1 — Thread Sight []

The Resonant Word style's foundation. Reads the most probable next action of a single target.

- **Effect:** Remote Sensing | **Subtype:** Fate

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Concentration (0 CP)

- **Additives:** none

- **Subtractives:** Concentration -2, Limited (one target only) -1

- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 3 = Rank 3; **ESL 3** (Improviser — Chronosynclastic is Improviser-dominant)

- **ÆP Cost:** 5

- **Use Case:** While concentrating on a single target, the caster knows their next most probable action one step before they take it. +2 to Dodge against that target's attacks. The Resonant Word dueling style's core buff — not seeing the future, reading probability.

8.2 — Severed Thread Strike []

The Severed Thread style's offensive escalation. A rapid strike that specifically targets the target's probability space — making their next defensive action slightly less likely to succeed.

- **Effect:** Weaken | **Subtype:** Fate

- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Minutes (1 CP)

- **Additives:** none

- **Subtractives:** Close Range Only -2

- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 - 2 = Rank 5; **ESL 5** (Improviser)

- **ÆP Cost:** 9

- **Use Case:** Reduces the target's effective Dodge and Deflect by weakening their probability of successful defense. In the Severed Thread doctrine, this stacks — each hit slightly reduces their defenses until they have no more probability of avoiding the outcome.

****8.3 — Cascade** [I]**

A rapid chain of attacks that carries forward the probability momentum of the first hit.

- ****Effect:**** Damage | ****Subtype:**** Fate
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Close (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Multiattack +3
- ****Subtractives:**** Close Range Only -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Additives 3 - 2 = Rank 5; ****ESL 5**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9
- ****Use Case:**** The Severed Thread style in mechanical form. Makes multiple attacks in one action. Each hit on the same target increases the probability weight against them — follow with Severed Thread Strike to compound the effect.

****8.4 — Probability Storm** [I]**

Creates a localized zone of causal chaos, making all outcomes within it wildly variable.

- ****Effect:**** Luck Control | ****Subtype:**** Fate
- ****Target:**** Spread (2 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Concentration (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Concentration -2, Uncentered Area -1
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Target 2 + Range 1 - 3 = Rank 6; ****ESL 6**** (Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 11
- ****Use Case:**** All creatures in the spread area must reroll any die result that would normally be certain (no natural 20s auto-succeed, no natural 1s auto-fail — all results are subject to random probability shift). The Unwritten Moment doctrine's signature area spell — the causal vandal's toolkit. Subject to Cosmic Arbitration (per the Luck Control effect — the GM may impose unintended consequences).

****8.5 — Preemptive Counter** [A]**

Sets a contingent counter-spell that activates the moment an observed target begins casting.

- ****Effect:**** Nullify | ****Subtype:**** Fate
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Medium (1 CP) | ****Duration:**** Concentration (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Triggered +2, Suspended +3
- ****Subtractives:**** Concentration -2, Limited (one specific target, spell must be observed initiating) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Additives 5 - 4 = Rank 8; Architect -3 = ****ESL 5****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9

- **Use Case:** The Resonant Word duelist's response to magic. While concentrating on a target, the caster has a counter-spell "loaded" that fires automatically when the target initiates spellcasting. This is not a reaction — it fires before the target's spell resolves because the Chronosynclastic saw it coming.

8.6 — Causal Delay [I]

Briefly suspends a target in a moment of frozen probability — they cannot act but also cannot be harmed.

- **Effect:** Affliction | **Subtype:** Time
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 = Rank 6; **ESL 6** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** The target is Stunned for one round — they cannot act, but also cannot be harmed (they are suspended in probability). Used tactically to remove a threat from the equation temporarily without committing to engagement. The Resonant Word practitioner uses this to create the perfect opening.

8.7 — Fate Echo [I]

The caster briefly experiences the consequences of an intended action before taking it, allowing them to reconsider.

- **Effect:** Remote Sensing | **Subtype:** Time
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Limited (one specific proposed action only) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 2 = Rank 4; **ESL 4** (Improviser)
- **ÆP Cost:** 7
- **Use Case:** The caster sees a brief flash of the most likely immediate consequence of one proposed action. Not a guarantee — a probability read, not a certainty. Useful for deciding whether to attack, flee, or negotiate. The Institute teaches this as basic situational awareness.

8.8 — Butterfly Mason [A]

A long-duration probability nudge applied to a location or situation, gradually steering outcomes toward a desired state.

- **Effect:** Luck Control | **Subtype:** Fate
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Touch (0 CP) | **Duration:** Week (4 CP)

- **Additives:** Insidious +2, Tenacious +2, Suspended +3
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 hour) -4, Limited (one specific situation or location) -2
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Duration 4 + Additives 7 - 8 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** The Chronosynclastic Institute's covert function in spell form. Applied to a situation, this nudges probability toward the desired outcome over a week without any visible magical signature. An election, a trade negotiation, a military campaign — the Butterfly Mason doesn't cause specific events, it increases the probability of desired patterns. Subject to Cosmic Arbitration. *The Institute considers this one of their most important proprietary spells.*

8.9 — Probability Read: Deep [A]

An extended divination session that produces a detailed probability assessment of a complex situation over multiple potential outcomes.

- **Effect:** Remote Sensing | **Subtype:** Fate
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 hour) -4, Check Required -2 (Praxeology skill check required)
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 8 = Rank -2; minimum **ESL 1**; Architect -4 (floored) = **ESL 1**
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** The Institute's commercial service. After an hour of ritual and a successful Praxeology skill check, the GM provides a detailed probability assessment of a complex situation — multiple outcomes, their relative likelihood, and the key variables affecting each. The Check Required subtractive means failure wastes the hour and produces nothing.

8.10 — Moment of Absolute Clarity [I]

The Resonant Word practitioner's supreme technique. For one round, the caster perceives all probability threads around them simultaneously.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Fate
- **Target:** Personal (0 CP) | **Range:** Self (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Sacrifice (Major) -4 (after the round ends, caster suffers Shaken on their Mental condition track — the weight of perfect clarity is psychologically taxing)
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 - 4 = Rank 1; **ESL 1** (Improviser) — but note this is a high Mastery requirement spell situationally
- **ÆP Cost:** 1

- **Use Case:** For one round, the caster cannot be surprised, has advantage on all defenses, and knows the optimal response to every situation in their immediate environment. The Sacrifice (Major) means they are Shaken afterward — they saw too much. Used at decisive moments only.

9. THE GENERALIST COLLEGE (PRAXIS COLLEGIUM)

Discipline: Synergetics | Primary subtypes: Variable (by design) | Secondary: Æther-forged, Academic

Note: Generalist spells are specifically designed to work across multiple Effect/Subtype combinations. Several use the Variable Effect or Variable Descriptor additive.

9.1 — Scholar's Gambit [A/I Polymath]

The foundational Generalist combat spell. A flexible damage delivery that can shift its Subtype as the situation demands.

- **Effect:** Damage | **Subtype:** Æther (base) with Variable Descriptor
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Medium (1 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** Variable Descriptor +2 (switch Subtype between Æther, Fire, Cold, Electricity at cast time)
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 1 + Subtype 3 + Range 1 + Additives 2 = Rank 7; **ESL 7** (no Architect reduction — built as Polymath)
- **ÆP Cost:** 13
- **Use Case:** The Scholar's Gambit in spell form. Not the most powerful damage spell — it is the most adaptable. Generalist graduates maintain this as their primary offensive tool precisely because it can shift to exploit weaknesses.

9.2 — Ward Survey [A]

Identifies all active magical effects, their origins, and their approximate power levels within the area.

- **Effect:** Senses | **Subtype:** Æther
- **Target:** Burst/Small (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** none
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Standard field survey. Reveals every active magical effect in the burst — its Effect type, approximate ESL, origin direction, and whether it is Architect or Improviser in

construction. The Generalist College's surveillance tool and the opening move of any Tesseraic Weaver operation.

****9.3 — Fulcrum** [A]**

Identifies the structural weakness in a target's active magical effects and applies minimum force to unravel them.

- ****Effect:**** Nullify | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Close (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- ****Additives:**** none
- ****Subtractives:**** Check Required -2 (Synergetics skill check required — on failure, no effect)
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 2 = Rank 4; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** The Tesseraic Weaver's core tool. A successful Synergetics check identifies the load-bearing component of the target's active magical effect and unravels it. More efficient than standard dispel — applies minimum force to achieve maximum result. On a failed check, the spell identifies nothing and has no effect.

****9.4 — Cross-Discipline Boost** [A]**

Temporarily enhances a target's effectiveness with a specific magical Effect or Subtype they already know.

- ****Effect:**** Enhanced Trait | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Affects Others +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Close Range Only -2, Limited (target must already know the Effect or Subtype being enhanced) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 2 - 4 = Rank 4; Architect -4 = ****ESL 1**** (minimum 1)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 1
- ****Use Case:**** Raises a target's effective Tier in a specific Effect or Subtype by 1 for the duration. A Generalist student on assignment with a Stormpeak contact boosts their Electricity Tier before the engagement. The Limited subtractive prevents this from granting access to entirely new magic — it only enhances what already exists.

****9.5 — Smoothing Protocol** [A]**

The Generalist College's reality maintenance tool. Temporarily stabilizes a Planar Bleed zone, reducing Strain accumulation for creatures within it.

- ****Effect:**** Nullify | ****Subtype:**** Æther

- **Target:** Spread (2 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (10 minutes) -3
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 + Target 2 + Duration 2 - 5 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** Reduces the Planar Strain accumulation rate in the area from 1/hour to 1/6 hours for the duration. The Generalist College uses this to allow operations in Bleed zones that would otherwise be dangerous for extended work. The Church of Aíon's Aevum Corps uses a more powerful version for infrastructure work.

9.6 — Establish Link [A]

Creates a communication link between two individuals, allowing mental speech over distance.

- **Effect:** Communication | **Subtype:** Mind
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Long (2 CP) | **Duration:** Hours (2 CP)
- **Additives:** Affects Others +2
- **Subtractives:** Ritual Components -1, Limited (both parties must consent) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Range 2 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 - 2 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = **ESL 6**
- **ÆP Cost:** 11
- **Use Case:** The standard Generalist field communication tool. Both parties can communicate telepathically at long range for hours. The Generalist network of covert agents uses this — the Unseen Seam's primary coordination method.

9.7 — Pattern Recognition [A]

After brief observation of a creature's behavior, the caster identifies its most likely tactical pattern.

- **Effect:** Mind Reading | **Subtype:** Æther
- **Target:** Individual (0 CP) | **Range:** Close (0 CP) | **Duration:** Instantaneous (0 CP)
- **Additives:** none
- **Subtractives:** Limited (1 full round of observation required) -1
- **Final Rank:** Effect 3 + Subtype 3 - 1 = Rank 5; Architect -4 = **ESL 1** (minimum 1)
- **ÆP Cost:** 1
- **Use Case:** After observing a target for one round, the caster gains insight into their combat style, likely next action, and dominant Psyche Schema tendencies. Not telepathy — behavioral analysis through magical pattern recognition. The Tesseraic Weaver's target assessment tool.

****9.8 — Adaptive Shield** [I]**

Protection that shifts its Subtype resistance to counter the last type of attack that hit the caster.

- ****Effect:**** Protection | ****Subtype:**** Æther (adapts)
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Minutes (1 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Variable Descriptor +2 (Subtype shifts to resist last damage type received)
- ****Subtractives:**** none
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 1 + Additives 2 = Rank 8; ****ESL 8****
(Improviser)
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 15
- ****Use Case:**** The Scholar's Gambit equivalent for defense. Takes a hit, immediately provides resistance to that type. The Generalist's adaptability philosophy in mechanical form — the second attack of the same type always hits a better-prepared target.

****9.9 — The Unseen Seam** [A]**

Renders the caster and all their active magical effects undetectable by Ward Survey, Planar Analysis, and similar detection spells for the duration.

- ****Effect:**** Concealment | ****Subtype:**** Æther
- ****Target:**** Personal (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Self (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Hours (2 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Subtle +2 (imperceptible to magical detection)
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -1
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 2 + Additives 2 - 1 = Rank 8; Architect -3 = ****ESL 5****
- ****ÆP Cost:**** 9
- ****Use Case:**** The Generalist covert arm's signature operational protection. While active, the caster cannot be detected by magical surveillance, ward surveys, or soul stone tracking systems. Named for the Generalist's intelligence network — the Unseen Seam. *Note: Soul stones still record the soul's presence — this spell conceals active magical signatures, not metaphysical existence.*

****9.10 — Sovereign NDA** [A]**

The Generalist College's binding secrecy protocol. Prevents a target from communicating specific information through any means for the duration.

- ****Effect:**** Affliction | ****Subtype:**** Order/Law
- ****Target:**** Individual (0 CP) | ****Range:**** Touch (0 CP) | ****Duration:**** Week (4 CP)
- ****Additives:**** Innate +2, Insidious +2, Affects Others +2
- ****Subtractives:**** Ritual Components -2, Increased Action (1 minute) -2, Limited (prevents communication of one specific category of information) -2
- ****Final Rank:**** Effect 2 + Subtype 3 + Duration 4 + Additives 6 - 6 = Rank 9; Architect -3 = ****ESL 6****

- **ÆP Cost:** 11

- **Use Case:** The literal "please sign the NDA." The target cannot communicate a specific category of information — verbally, in writing, through magical Communication, or through any other means — for one week. Standard operating procedure when the Generalist College reads anyone into classified operations. *The Insidious additive means targets often don't realize why they suddenly cannot articulate certain thoughts.*

End of 90 Iconic Spells — Alpha Draft

All spells use only Effects, Subtypes, Additives, Subtractives, and geometry components from the Book of Shadows v6. ESL caps are per the lesser of Effect Tier and Subtype Tier. ÆP costs are $(ESL \times 2) - 1$. CP costs use the Construction Menu tables. Architect Recipe Optimization applied where marked [A]. No mechanics invented beyond what the source document provides.